ICSB
IOT | CYBER SECURITY | BLOCKCHAIN

IEEE SMC
Systems, Man, and Cybernetics Society

PRESENT

THE FOUNDER'S ARENA

CODE THE SOLUTION. BUILD THE VISION. PITCH THE FUTURE.



20	5	2	2
TEAMS	MEMBERS PER TEAM	DAYS	GRAND PRIZES

DATE
November
17th & 18th, 2026

VENUE
Seminar Hall, P.A. College
of Engineering, Mangaluru

TIME
9 AM – 4 PM
(Both days)

SELECTION BASED ON PPT ROUND - TOP 20 TEAMS | Scan the QR on page 3

THE BIG IDEA

What is The Founder's Arena?

A hackathon and Shark Tank rolled into one. In 2 days, your team of 5 spots a real-world problem, builds a working product, creates a startup brand, and pitches to judges who act as investors. You don't just build an app. You build a business.

Build anything: web apps, mobile apps, hardware/IoT, AI solutions or software platforms.

YOUR JOURNEY

1 Pick a domain
Choose 1 of 20 domain sheets

2 Find a problem
A real, meaningful problem worth solving

3 Build & brand
Product, logo, chart paper & promo reel

4 Pitch & win
Present to judges acting as investors

THE 5 ROLES (every teammate gets one)

CEO — Chief Executive Officer
Introduces the startup, vision, mission and long-term goals

CTO — Chief Technology Officer
Explains the tech, demos the product, proves feasibility

CPO — Chief Product Officer
Presents the problem, solution, features and unique value

CFO — Chief Financial Officer
Explains the revenue model, growth and the investment ask

CMO — Chief Marketing Officer
Owns branding, marketing strategy and the promo reel

Judges can ask ANY member anything, so everyone must know the whole product and business.

THE 2-DAY PLAN

DAY 1 Build Day | Nov 17

- Build a working product with its core features
- Finalise a unique startup name, logo and brand
- Make a physical chart paper presentation
- Produce a 30–60 second promo reel
- Product must be complete by 4:30 PM
- At least 2 teammates stay at the workstation

DAY 2 Investor Pitch | Nov 18

- Introduce your startup, problem and solution
- Give a live demo of your working product
- Present your chart paper
- Explain your business model and revenue
- State your investment ask and how you will use it
- Answer the judges' questions as a team

SELECTION ROUND

Participation is based on a PPT selection round. Only the top 20 teams will be selected.

WHAT YOUR CHART PAPER MUST SHOW

1. Startup name and logo
2. Selected domain
3. Problem statement
4. Proposed solution
5. Product overview
6. Key features
7. Target audience
8. Unique selling point (USP)
9. Business model
10. Visuals: screenshots, diagrams, photos

Tip: make it so clear that someone who has never seen your project gets it in 30 seconds.

PROMOTIONAL REEL (30–60 SECONDS)

- Introduce your startup and its product
- Show the problem and your solution
- Highlight the key benefits for users
- Use creative storytelling and branding to attract customers and investors

Made by the CMO and submitted on Day 1 with your product, branding and chart paper. Tip: open with a hook in the first 5 seconds.

HOW YOU'LL BE JUDGED

Problem and Innovation
Is the problem real and the solution original?

Product and Design
Do the core features work? Is it usable?

Chart and Communication
Is your chart clear and convincing?

Business and Scalability
Clear revenue model, market and growth?

Pitch and Teamwork
Structured, confident, well coordinated?

Answers to Judges
Can you justify your tech and business choices?

Final scoring weightage will be announced by the organisers.

AWARDS

1 **Overall First Place**
Strongest mix of innovation, product, business and pitch.

2 **Overall Second Place**
Second-highest overall performance.

Only two prizes. Investment money is dummy and only for simulation, not actual funding.

READY TO BECOME A FOUNDER?

Selection is based on the PPT round. Only the top 20 teams get in.

SCAN TO REGISTER

FOR QUERIES, CONTACT

Muhammad Haashid
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PPT Selection Criteria

Every PPT submission is evaluated on the four criteria below.

DOMAINS

1 DOMAIN 1
Rural Development & Social Innovation

2 DOMAIN 2
FinTech & Financial Inclusion

EVALUATION CRITERIA

1 CRITERION 1
Problem Clarity & Theme Fit
Is the problem clear and real, and does it fit the chosen domain?

2 CRITERION 2
Innovation & Solution Quality
Is the idea original and the solution well thought out?

3 CRITERION 3
Impact & Target Users
Who benefits, and how much difference will it make?

4 CRITERION 4
Technical Feasibility
Can it realistically be built with the proposed tech?

Final scoring weightage will be announced by the organisers.

PPT TEMPLATE

STANDARD PPT TEMPLATE

Prepare your PPT using the official template

Fill in every section and upload the finished PPT through the registration form.

OPEN PPT TEMPLATE

Link: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1rpwEkumI3yE7qR-lXjFXr9p_FahzhR7d/edit?usp=drive_link&ouid=115607313639692877914&rtpof=true&sd=true

SCAN FOR TEMPLATE